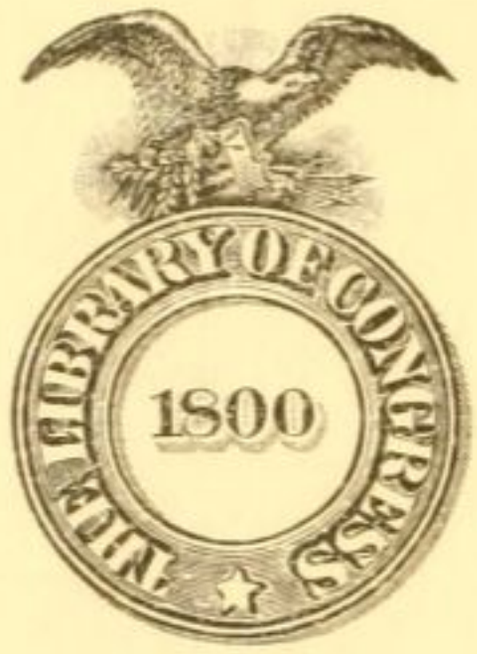
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59TH CONGRESS, 1st Session. } HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES. { DOCUMENT No. 714.

U. S. War dept.

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RELIEF FOR SAN FRANCISCO.

MESSAGE

FROM THE

PRESIDENT OF THE UNITED STATES,

SUBMITTING

A LETTER OF THE SECRETARY OF WAR, WITH ACCOMPANYING DOCUMENTS, INCLUDING A FORM OF A RESOLUTION SUGGESTED FOR PASSAGE BY THE CONGRESS.

APRIL 21, 1906.—Read; referred to the Committee on Appropriations and ordered to be printed.

To the Senate and House of Representatives:

I submit herewith a letter of the Secretary of War, with accompanying documents, including a form of a resolution suggested for passage by the Congress.

This letter refers to the appalling catastrophe which has befallen San Francisco and neighboring cities, a catastrophe more appalling than any other of the kind that has befallen any portion of our country during its history. I am sure that there is need on my part of no more than a suggestion to the Congress in order that this resolution may be at once passed, but I urge that instead of appropriating a further sum of $1,000,000, as recommended by the Secretary of War, the appropriation be for a million and a half dollars. The supplies already delivered or en route for San Francisco approximate in value a million and a half dollars, which is more than we have the authority in law as yet to purchase. I do not think it safe for us to reckon upon the need of spending less than a million in addition. Large sums are being raised by private subscription in this country, and very generous offers have been made to assist us by individuals of other countries, which requests, however, I have refused, as in my judgment there is no need of any assistance from outside our own borders—this refusal, of course, in no way lessening our deep appreciation of the kindly sympathy which has prompted such offers.

The detailed account of the action of the War Department is contained in the appendices to the letter of the Secretary of War. At the moment our concern is purely with meeting the terrible emergency of the moment.

Later I shall communicate with you as to the generous part which I am sure the National Government will take in meeting the more permanent needs of the situation, including, of course, rebuilding the great governmental structures which have been destroyed.

I hope that the action above requested can be taken to-day.

THEODORE ROOSEVELT.

THE WHITE HOUSE, *April 21, 1906.*

WAR DEPARTMENT,
Washington, April 21, 1906.

MY DEAR MR. PRESIDENT: The situation in San Francisco is such as to require an additional appropriation from Congress to meet the necessities of the people of that stricken city who are immediately in need of shelter and food. The War Department has rendered all the assistance possible, beginning its orders as soon as the first telegram was received from General Funston, about midnight of the 18th instant. Indeed a telegram was sent by Assistant Secretary Oliver to General Funston immediately upon the receipt of the news of the earthquake on the morning of the 18th, directing him to render all assistance possible. From the night of the 18th of April all the available stores of the Army of three departments have been used for relief purposes, assuming that the action of this Department would be ratified by Congress in accordance with precedents in similar cases.

The memorandum of the General Staff, which accompanies this letter, shows the telegrams received from General Funston, which gradually developed the extent of the terrible disaster and increased the amount of supplies of every kind needed.

All subsistence and quartermaster's supplies and all medical stores of every kind which were in the military depots in San Francisco were destroyed, except the local supplies for the troops stationed at the post of the Presidio at San Francisco. Accordingly, everything had to be ordered from a distance. There are now on the way, by special express trains, from every available and convenient point where they were stored, 900,000 rations, which means the rations for 900,000 soldiers for one day. The value of these rations is estimated by the Commissary-General to be $198,000. Two hundred thousand of these rations have probably reached San Francisco this morning, in charge of commissary officers.

The Quartermaster's Department have expressed by special train wall tents, conical tents, hospital tents, and storage tents for the shelter of 100,000 people; 100,000 blankets, 7,500 mattresses, 11,500 bed sacks, and 8,000 cots, part of which have already reached San Francisco from the immediate vicinity, and all of which are hastening to the city by special trains, which have been given precedence over passenger trains.

The quartermaster's supplies already delivered in San Francisco or en route by special express trains in charge of competent military quartermasters amount in value to $1,031,734.40.

The Medical Bureau of this Department has sent five carloads of medical supplies from St. Louis by express in charge of competent medical officers and hospital stewards. The estimated value of these medical supplies is $50,000.

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It is estimated that the cost of transportation for all these supplies amounts to $150,000, so that the cost of that which has already been done in the matter of relief for San Francisco is $1,429,734.40.

On the 19th Congress passed the following resolution:

Resolved, That the Secretary of War is hereby authorized and directed to procure, in open market or otherwise, subsistence and quartermaster's supplies, in addition to such supplies belonging to the military establishment and available, and issue the same to such destitute persons who have been rendered homeless or are in needy circumstances as a result of the earthquake which occurred April eighteenth and the pending conflagration, and in executing this joint resolution the Secretary of War is directed to cooperate with the authorities of the State of California and the mayors of the cities in San Francisco, Berkeley, Oakland, Alameda, and such other cities on the Pacific coast as may have sustained damage.

Be it further resolved, That the Secretary of the Treasury, the Secretary of the Navy, and Secretary of Commerce and Labor are hereby directed to cooperate with the Secretary of War in extending relief and assistance to these stricken people herein referred to, to the extent of the use of the naval vessels, revenue cutters, and other vessels, and Government supplies under their control on the Pacific coast.

Be it further resolved, That to enable the Secretary of War to execute the provisions of this joint resolution, there is hereby appropriated, out of any money in the Treasury not otherwise appropriated, the sum of one million dollars, to be expended under the direction and under the discretion of the Secretary of War.

On the 20th, at my suggestion, the resolution was amended so as to include medical supplies, as follows:

Resolved, That the appropriation of one million dollars, made by joint resolution approved the nineteenth instant, entitled "Joint resolution for the relief of sufferers from earthquake and conflagration on the Pacific coast," shall be available, under the discretion of the Secretary of War, to procure medical supplies, in addition to such supplies belonging to the Military Establishment, and issue the same in like manner as the subsistence and quartermaster's supplies specifically mentioned in the joint resolution aforesaid.

I have the honor to recommend that Congress be requested to appropriate $1,000,000 more, in order to meet the cost already incurred over and above the $1,000,000 appropriated, and to enable the War Department to purchase such additional supplies as may be needed for the purpose.

The present resolution authorizes the expenditure of money for the relief of San Francisco. The supplies which have been sent have been taken out of the Regular Army depots, and were necessary for the support and use of the Army. I respectfully suggest, therefore, that in the next resolution, which I hope Congress may pass, specific authority be given to the Secretary of War to use both the $1,000,000 already appropriated and the amount which may be appropriated in the recommended resolution either to purchase supplies for the relief of San Francisco or to replace by purchase the supplies taken from the Regular Army stores for such relief purposes.

I inclose the form of resolution which will accomplish the result sought.

I attach the memorandum of the Chief of Staff, the report of the Quartermaster-General, and the report of the Commissary-General, with their accompanying telegrams and estimates. I also attach a memorandum from the Surgeon-General as to his operations and needs.

The loss of the valuable subsistence, quartermaster's and medical stores assembled in the depot at San Francisco, for use at the Pacific posts and in the Philippines, will require a very considerable deficiency estimate, in order that they, in addition to the stores now being used for the relief of San Francisco, may be replaced.

The loss may be approximated as follows:

Commissary stores	$150,000
Quartermaster's stores	2,941,472
Medical stores	357,391
Total	3,448,863

I shall submit estimates for these at a later date.

Very respectfully, yours,

WM. H. TAFT, *Secretary of War.*

The PRESIDENT.

Resolved, That one million dollars, in addition to the one million dollars already provided in joint resolution of April nineteenth, as amended by the resolution of April twentieth, for the relief of persons suffering as the result of the earthquake occurring April eighteenth, in California, is hereby appropriated, out of any money in the Treasury not otherwise appropriated, to be expended under the direction and discretion of the Secretary of War, and authority is hereby specifically given to the Secretary of War to use these appropriations, amounting in all to two million dollars, not only to buy additional supplies which may be needed for the relief of the sufferers, as directed in said resolutions of April nineteenth and April twentieth, but also for the purpose of replacing, by purchase, such subsistence, quartermaster's, and medical supplies as may have been furnished by the Secretary of War for such relief from the stores on hand for the use of the Army.

[For the Secretary of War: Memorandum of information received and orders given touching relief work in San Francisco.]

WAR DERARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF OF STAFF,
Washington, April 21, 1906.

Shortly after midnight on the night of April 18–19, a message just received from General Funston by the Secretary of War, concerning supplies needed by the destitute and homeless in San Francisco, was repeated to me by telephone, with instructions from the Secretary to proceed at once to my office for conference regarding measures for relief. Other messages were almost immediaetly received, and after they were read to the Secretary I received instructions to proceed, with the Quartermaster-General and the Commissary-General, to give the necessary orders to forward supplies at the earliest practicable moment to General Funston. The Quartermaster-General and the Commissary-General were both called to the telegraph office.

The transactions by the Quartermaster-General and the Commissary-General for the next two days pursuant to these instructions, will be found in their memorandum reports, together with copies of all telegraphic messages sent and received by them in this connection. All other telegrams sent by the War Department concerning relief supplies will be found attached hereto.

Respectfully submitted.

J. F. BELL,
Brigadier-General, Chief of Staff.

No. 1.

SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., *April 18, 1906.*
(Received 11.40 p. m.)

The SECRETARY OF WAR, *Washington:*

We need thousands of tents and all rations that can be sent. Business portion of city destroyed and about 100,000 people homeless. Fire still raging; troops all on duty assisting police. Loss of life probably 1,000. Best part of resident district not yet burned.

FUNSTON.

No. 2.

OAKLAND PIER, CAL., *April 18.*
(Received 2.50 a. m. 19th.)

MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington:*

We are doing all possible to aid residents of San Francisco in present terrible calamity. Many thousands homeless. I shall do everything in my power to render assistance, and trust to War Department to authorize any action I may have to take. Army casualties will be reported later. All important papers saved. We need tents and rations for 20,000 people.

FUNSTON.

No. 3.

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.* (Sent at 4 a. m.)

General FUNSTON, *San Francisco, Cal.:*

Your dispatch calling for tents and rations for 20,000 people received. Have directed sending of 200,000 rations from Vancouver Barracks, nearest available point. Will give orders concerning tents immediately, and advise you within an hour. Do you need more troops? Of course, do everything possible to assist in keeping order, in saving life and property, and in relieving hunger by use of troops, material, and supplies under your orders. House passed enabling resolution to-day and Senate will to-morrow. All railway and telegraphic facilities surrounding San Francisco reported badly damaged and demoralized. Officers will accompany supplies where necessary, in order to insure as prompt forwarding and delivery as possible, with orders to keep in touch with you when practicable.

TAFT, *Secretary of War.*

No. 4.

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.* (Sent at 4.55 a. m.)

General FUNSTON, *San Francisco:*

All available hospital, wall, and conical wall tents will be sent at once by express from Vancouver, Douglas, Logan, Russell, San Antonio, Monterey, Snelling, and Sheridan. Remainder will be sent from Philadelphia depot. Little definite information thus far received as to limits of burned districts or conditions. Wire details as comprehensively as possible.

TAFT, *Secretary of War.*

No. 5.

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF COLUMBIA,
Vancouver Barracks, Wash.:

Secretary of War directs you have commissary, Vancouver Barracks, send 200,000 rations to depot commissary, San Francisco; also all available hospital, wall, and conical wall tents to depot quartermaster, with least delay possible, by quickest practicable route, either by water or rail. All railroad and telegraph facilities surrounding San Francisco reported badly damaged and demoralized. Have an officer accompany these stores, with view to seeing that they are forwarded and delivered promptly as possible, and instruct him to keep in touch, by wire, with General Funston when practicable. Acknowledge receipt and report action.

BELL, *Chief of Staff.*

No. 6.

VANCOUVER BARRACKS, WASH., *April 19, 1906.*

CHIEF OF STAFF,
War Department, Washington:

Just received your telegram of this date. Orders have been issued accordingly. Chief commissary now in Portland purchasing rations. Will report results in accordance with instructions received last night from division commander. The commanding officers of all posts in this department outside of Alaska have been ordered to ship all available tentage and all rations in excess of twenty days' allowance by quickest route, whether by rail or steamer, to San Francisco.

WILLIAMS,
Brigadier-General, Commanding.

3.55 p. m.

No. 7.

VANCOUVER BARRACKS, WASH., *April 19, 1906.*

CHIEF OF STAFF,
War Department, Washington, D. C.:

With reference to your telegram 18th regarding shipment all available tentage at Vancouver with officer to San Francisco, orders have been given and prompt action taken.

WILLIAMS,
Brigadier-General, Commanding.

3.56 p. m.

No. 8.

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.* (Sent at 6.45 a. m.

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF DAKOTA,
St. Paul, Minn.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents, complete, that are now at Fort Snelling. Send competent officer with shipment to see to prompt delivery at San Francisco.

By order of the Secretary of War:

BELL, *Chief of Staff.*

NOTE.—Similar telegrams also sent affecting Fort Sheridan, Fort D. A. Russell, Fort Sam Houston, Vancouver, Monterey.

No. 9.

[Memorandum.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF OF STAFF,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

Captain Ross, of the Revenue-Cutter Service, called and offered the services of certain vessels in the Revenue Service for use in transporting tents, commissary supplies, etc., provided by the Army, to the destitute and homeless sufferers of the earthquake at San Francisco. The following vessels were mentioned:

The *Perry*, at Astoria, Oreg.; displacement about 500 or 600 tons (a seagoing vessel, which can go to Vancouver Barracks, Portland, Seattle, Tacoma, etc., at once).

The *McCullough*, at San Francisco; displacement about 1,200 tons (a seagoing vessel of considerably greater capacity than the *Perry;* can reach Portland in about two and a half days, making round trip to San Francisco in five days, exclusive of time required for loading. This vessel can go anywhere desired).

The *Hartley*, the *Golden Gate*—two tugs, which can be utilized for transporting supplies from the Presidio to San Francisco. They are now in San Francisco Harbor.

At the suggestion of the Chief of Staff Captain Ross said he would communicate with the master of the *Perry*, directing him to at once proceed to Vancouver Barracks and report to the commanding general, Department of the Columbia, for the purpose of transporting War Department supplies from that post and Portland to San Francisco, provided the railroads are not open in time to admit of supplies being sent to San Francisco quicker by rail than by water.

No. 10.

APRIL 19, 1906.

Captain Ross, Revenue-Cutter Service, telephoned to the Chief of Staff that he had just sent the following telegrams:

TREASURY DEPARTMENT, *Washington, D. C.*

Captain TUTTLE,
Revenue Cutter Perry, Astoria, Oreg.:

Proceed at once with *Perry* to Vancouver Barracks. Report commanding general to transport at once supplies San Francisco, if required. Carry out instructions of commanding general, and keep this Department advised.

TAYLOR,
Assistant Secretary.

No. 11.

TREASURY DEPARTMENT, *Washington, D. C.*

Captain HAMLET,
Revenue Cutter Chetis, Oakland, Cal.:

Direct all officers and men and *McCullough*, *Hartley*, and *Golden Gate* to assist General Funston in every respect. You are directed to take charge revenue-cutter forces. Keep this Department advised. This telegram authority.

TAYLOR, *Assistant Secretary.*

No. 12.

SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., *April 19, 1906.*

MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Your four dispatches received. Have already filed several for you. Impossible now to inform you as to full extent of disaster. City practically destroyed. Troops have been aiding police patrolling and maintaining order. Martial law has not been declared. Working in conjunction with civil authorities. Have not interferred with sending of any dispatches. You can not send too many tents or rations. About 200,000 people homeless. Food very scarce. Provision houses all destroyed. All Government buildings in city gone.

FUNSTON.

9.11 a. m.

No. 13.

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.*

General FUNSTON, *San Francisco, Cal.:*

Reference your telegram this date, Secretary of War directs me to inform you Quartermaster-General has been directed to forward to San Francisco all available canvas now in possession of Army. Commissary-General has been directed to send from nearest shipping points two hundred thousand additional rations. Admiral McCalla, Mare Island, will be instructed to confer with you and turn over any food supplies that can be spared from stores at Mare Island; also to furnish any available canvas suitable for making improvised shelter.

J. F. BELL, *Chief of Staff.*

No. 14.

SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., *April 19, 1906.*

THE MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Latest report regarding railroad communications as follows: Ferry building and wharves to the north of Market street intact and out danger. Ferries running regularly to Sausalito, Tiburon, and Oakland. Railroad officials have established office in ferry building. Trains now running regularly, via Stockton, to the East and North. Report is that regular train service will be kept up. Large number of people leaving by ferries. Fire situation progressing same as reported in telegram of 10.30.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

4.19 p. m.

No. 15.

FORT MASON, CAL., *April 19–20, 1906.*

THE MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington.*

Fire entirely out of control and now at Octavia street. As previously reported, practically the whole city will be destroyed. Have ordered all available troops from Vancouver Barracks to report as soon as possible. Conditions as yet are quiet, and civil authorities, assisted by the military authorities, are making every possible effort to control the situation, which is fully as well (sic) as could be expected under the circumstances. The weather continues fine and for the present no great suffering from the cold is anticipated. My telegram to Monterey ordering troops up from there not delivered. Can you not communicate with them from Washington, and order to report as soon as possible? All the cavalry wanted and two battalions of infantry, with all available rations.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

No. 16.

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

COMMANDING OFFICER, PRESIDIO OF MONTEREY,
Monterey, Cal.:

Following telegram received from General Funston:

"My telegram to Monterey, ordering troops up from there, not delivered. Can you not communicate with them from Washington, and order to report as soon as possible? All the cavalry wanted and two battalions of infantry, with all available rations."

Has this telegram been received? Answer immediately.

AINSWORTH, *Military Secretary.*

No. 17.

PRESIDIO, MONTEREY, CAL., *April 20, 1906.*
(Via Salina, Cal.)

MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Dispatch repeated by you received by naval torpedo boat this morning; immediate action is being taken to comply therewith.

GARRAD, *Commanding.*

No. 18.

SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., *April 19, 1906.*

THE MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Fire crossed Van Ness avenue to west at 3.30 p. m. Almost certain now that entire city will be distroyed. Have ordered troops from Monterey and everything is going as well as could be expected. On account of confusion it has been impossible to locate individuals inquired for, but attention will be given to that matter as practicable.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

No. 19.

OAKLAND, CAL., *April 19, 1906.*

MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Burned district now approximately as follows:

From water front up Broadway to Mason street, thence south to California street, thence west to Jones, thence diagonally to Van Ness and Golden Gate avenue. All this line now actively burning. Fire on following line practically out:

From Van Ness west on Golden Gate avenue to Fillmore, thence south to Market, thence on irregular line to Valencia and Twenty-sixth, thence irregular line east to bay. Indications are that active fire line will advance west to Van Ness and north to Union and Montgomery avenue. About 300,000 people homeless. Everything quiet. Troops cooperating with police. Famine seems inevitable. All large supply stores burned. Most energetic efforts from outside only can prevent frightful suffering. Weather now fine, and it is expected to remain so. I request that everything possible be done in the way of food supplies, tentage, and blankets. No more troops needed at present.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

No. 20.

FERRY SLIP, *San Francisco, Cal., April 19, 1906.*

The MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Official report at these headquarters this date states that the subtreasury is entirely destroyed by fire, with the exception of the vaults, which contain all cash on hand. Suitable guards have been ordered to protect this money.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

8.40 p. m.

No. 21.

SAN FRANCISCO.

The Western Union and Southern Pacific buildings totally destroyed. The fire is burning rapidly in a diagonal line up the hill, commencing at McAllister and ending at Battery street, and on Mission street as far as Sixteenth street. The water supply has given out, the wind rising, and the military authorities have just forbidden any one to enter the city; they have all they can handle without admitting any more. Situation has not improved, and already there is great suffering for food and water. I saw a line of thousands of people lined up in a park awaiting soldiers to distribute water.

No. 22.

PRESIDIO OF SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., 19.

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Answering yours, am issuing 3,000 common wall tents in store at Presidio storehouses; also 1,000 buckets, 1,000 blankets. Will continue issue until stock exhausted. Lack of water very serious. Can probably take care of tentage as fast as it arrives. No stoves needed. Owing to blowing cinders, warehouses in some danger at Presidio. All storehouses in city totally destroyed with contents except storage of officers' effects. Dock and all transports uninjured. Have moved records and office to Presidio.

DEVOL, *Quartermaster.*

No. 23.

FORT MASON, CAL., *April 19, 1906.*

THE MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

In answer to telegram Secretary of War to-day, regarding water supply, will say present indications are that sufficient supply will be on hand for drinking and cooking. Further information not yet on hand. Will wire as early as possible more definite information. Large springs at Labos Creek, Presidio, and lakes of fresh water at Golden Gate Park; also considerable supply by pipe line now reported.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

No. 24.

FORT MASON, CAL., *April 20, 1906.*

THE MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Fire situation at 7 o'clock this morning better. The fire has been stopped practically at Franklin street. Hose now being stretched from Franklin and Broadway toward Russian Hill, about Union and Leavenworth, and from there irregularly toward Telegraph Hill. It is hoped to stop the fire on that line; south of Market fire has passed to west of Dolores street, but north of Market entire line under control from about Fillmore and Market on irregular line to Van Ness and Broadway. That region of city west of this line and north of Market will probably be saved. Weather continues fine.

Supplies arriving; situation appears a little better than was anticipated at midnight; will keep you advised of progress.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

No. 25.

SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., *April 20, 1906.*

MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

9 a. m. Reference to water supply can now report as follows:

Springvalley water people state that they will be able to deliver to the city to-day by pipe line 10,000,000 gallons of water. This, together with Labos Creek and the

Golden Gate Park system, which is a separate system, will supply all people in the two large concentration camps located as follows: One between Fort Mason and the Presidio, including both posts, and one in Golden Gate Park; a third large concentration camp is located south of the Protrero in the hills.

No pipe line reach the latter, but energetic arrangements are progressing to supply this camp by wagon and boat. No water famine is anticipated. The fire is getting under better control as reported in telegram of 7 a. m. this morning. Fire is not getting west of Franklin; still being held in check on line from Pacific avenue across Russian Hill to Telegraph Hill; fire boats assisting in pumping from the bay.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

No. 26.

VANCOUVER BARRACKS, WASH., *April 20, 1906.*

MILITARY SECRETARY,
War Department, Washington, D. C.:

Special train 17 cars left Portland 10 p. m., 19th instant, with 200,000 rations and 477 tents, in charge Lieutenant Kobes, Fourteenth Infantry. Expect arrive San Francisco early Saturday morning.

WILLIAMS,
Brigadier-General, Commanding.

No. 27.

HEADQUARTERS DEPARTMENT OF CALIFORNIA,
Fort Mason, San Francisco, Cal, April 20, 1906.

THE MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

At this hour, 8.30 p. m., a hard and probably successful fight is being made to save western part of city. Fort Mason, where army headquarters have been established, may go, but we will know in an hour. Supplies arriving and are being distributed to homeless people camped in parks, military reservations, and vacant spaces. Troops, police, and firemen almost exhausted by three days' terrible work. Conduct of people in general has been admirable, though in some cases looters have been shot. Admiral Goodrich has landed all available men from fleet and placed under my orders. Seventy cavalry, under Major Benson, guarding ruins of banks, where there are many millions in vaults. Impossible as yet to learn of individuals for whom you inquired. Most casualties were in poorer districts, south of Market street. Not many killed in better portions of city.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

The following was received after the report had been completed at 6 o'clock a. m., April 21:

NAVAL TRAINING STATION,
San Francisco, Cal., April 20, 1906.

MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Fire is making no progress to the west from Van Ness avenue. West wind of considerable force now beginning. Indications now that all that part of the city south of Van Ness avenue and north of the bay will be destroyed. Some considerable apprehension is felt as to the post of Fort Mason, but it is believed that we can save it. Weather continues fine and warm; practically no suffering from the cold. It will be impossible to at once establish proper sanitary conditions; much sickness must necessarily be expected. If the city to the west now standing remains intact, there are many good buildings that can be used as hospitals. The water supply is encouraging. The Spring Valley water people believe they can deliver from ten to twelve million gallons daily. This, with other sources not mentioned, will prevent water famine.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

FORT MASON,
San Francisco, Cal., April 20.

SECRETARY OF WAR, *Washington, D. C.:*

At this hour, 11 p. m., remainder of residence section known as Western Addition seems out of danger. Fire still bad on water front. Every effort being made to save wharves. Fort Mason safe.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL,
Washington, April 20, 1906.

SIR: Early on the morning of the 19th instant the undersigned was called for consultation with the Chief of Staff, to take immediate steps for the relief of sufferers by the earthquake and resulting fires at San Francisco, and orders were then and there given to the commanding generals of the Departments to ship by express to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, Cal., all wall, conical, and hospital tents, complete, that were at Forts Vancouver, Snelling, Sheridan, D. A. Russell, Sam Houston, Monterey, Logan, and Douglas, and also to the depot quartermaster at Philadelphia to ship by express at once to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, tentage, complete, with stores, etc., sufficient to accommodate 20,000 men as called for by General Funston.

The fire having increased, General Funston called for increased supplies, and later in the day the amount of tentage was increased to include 100,000 men by calling upon the depot quartermasters at Chicago, Omaha, St. Louis, Jeffersonville, and Boston, in addition to Philadelphia, and in the evening there were ordered blankets, pillows, cots, bed sacks, etc., to the extent of the supply not in the hands of troops. These were all dispatched by express trains, each accompanied by an officer or quartermaster's agent, and the last of these supplies were on the road by the evening of this day, that ordered yesterday morning having all been en route before or during the night. These were all consigned to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, to be distributed under the direction of the commanding general, and it is not to be presumed that more than is necessary will be used by him.

Exhibit A, herewith, shows in detail the number, kind, and cost of tents, blankets, cots, etc., supplied by each depot, and it is estimated that the cost of transportation by express for this large amount, with incidental expenses that may and probably will arise, and also the like cost for commissary and medical supplies, will approximate $150,000. In every case the quartermasters and other officers involved have acknowledged the receipt of the orders for shipment and have either stated that the supplies were en route or would be to-night, April 20. Railroads are cooperating with the Department in expediting the shipment of this property, having given the supply trains right of way over all passenger or other trains. This office is in receipt of a telegram from Governor Mead, of Washington, stating that he had between 300 and 400 tents available which he could ship to San Francisco. Request has been sent to him that he ship these tents, consigned to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, by first steamer. Also, a telegram from Governor Mickey, of Nebraska, asking permission to ship tents and blankets in the hands of the Nebraska National Guard to San Francisco for relief of sufferers. Request was sent to the governor to consign tents and blankets to depot quartermaster, San Francisco. The Union Pacific Railroad had agreed to rush shipment through free of cost. The cost of tentage, etc., sent by the two governors is not included in this estimate.

Very respectfully,

C. F. HUMPHREY,
Quartermaster-General, U. S. Army.

The SECRETARY OF WAR.

EXHIBIT A.

Statement showing in detail the various articles of tentage and bedding supplied and ordered shipped by the Quartermaster's Department to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco; including articles distributed by the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, from the Presidio of San Francisco, with the money value of same, also the estimated cost of tentage transferred from other posts.

	Philadelphia.	Chicago.	Omaha.	St. Louis.	Jefferson.	New York.	Boston.	Total.	Presidio of San Francisco.	Cost.	Total value.
Common:											
Drab	1,993			231	271			2,495		$12.74	$31,786.30
Khaki				2				2	3,000	12.74	38,245.48
White				11	373			384		12.74	4,892.16
Poles, ridge				2,893				2,893		.27	781.11
Poles, upright				5,790				6,590		.27	1,449.30
Conical:											
Improved, complete	499					22		511		38.55	19,699.05
Regulation drab					9			9		.98	296.82
Regulation khaki	3,425				5	307		3,737		32.98	123,246.26
Regulation white	13				7			20		32.98	659.60
Poles	3,967			21				3,788		.62	2,348.56
Stoves			3,500	350				3,850		.97	3,734.50
Stovepipe	10,169	500	5,297	11,824				34,190		.07	2,393.30
Stove tripods	3,425			21				3,446		1.29	4,445.34
Hospital:											
Drab	124			31	6			161		44.86	7,222.46
Khaki	873			138	2	125		1,138		44.86	51,050.68
White					25	2		27		44.86	1,211.22
Flies, drab	78			4				78		14.30	1,115.40
Flies, khaki	936		24	124				1,084		14.30	15,501.20
Files, white					12			12		14.30	171.60
Poles, ridge				1,493				1,493		.96	1,433.28
Poles, upright				2,986				2,986		.96	2,866.56
Munson's, complete				34				34		96.50	3,281.00
Munson's flies, complete				11				11		20.76	228.36
Improved, with pole	34							34		74.64	2,537.76
Flies with pole	25							25		20.76	519.00
Storage:											
Flies	23	312		29				364		70.84	25,785.76
Poles	26			23		211		260		19.08	4,960.80
Wall:											
Drab	335							335		11.86	3,972.10
Khaki	6							6		20.63	123.78
White	2,455				2			2,457		20.63	50,687.81
Improved, with poles	1,760							1,760		24.93	43,687.80
Flies, drab	304				2			306		7.31	2,236.86
Flies, khaki	2,157				2			2,159		7.31	15,782.29

Flies, improved	1,760							1,760		9.13	16,068.80
Poles, ridge	2,461				68			2,529		.32	809.28
Poles, up	4,922				136			5,058		.32	1,618.56
Pins:											
Large	43,020			19,000	44,086			66,106		.02	132.12
Small	43,000	170,000		32,000	29,462			274,462		.01	4,116.93
Blankets:											
Light	8,174			612	60,557			69,343		2.48	171,970.64
Olive-drab, heavy	18,777						6,567	25,344		5.24	132,802.56
Blue, heavy									1,000	3.49	3,490.00
Mattresses	7,478		51	4,800	47		213	12,589		1.89	23,793.21
Bed sacks	11,400		283	983	1,426			14,092		.91	12,823.72
Mattress covers	4,029		849	4,926		13,359		23,163		.79	18,289.77
G. M. cots	7,637			327				7,964		1.61	12,822.04
Tents, flood sufferers:											
Common, white				190							
Conical—											
Drab				3							
Khaki				6							
White				16	[a]						[b] 41,800.00
Hospital—											
Drab				1,045							
White				365							
Flies, drab				554							
Flies, white				69							
Total											909,109.13

[a] Latest order to St. Louis Depot. Acknowledged receipt will go forward on 20th.

[b] Estimated.

WAR DEPARTMENT, *Office of the Quartermaster-General, April 20, 1906.*

EXHIBIT B.

Statement showing in detail the various articles of tentage, etc., supplied and ordered shipped by the Quartermaster Department to the depot quartermaster at San Francisco, Cal, from the posts enumerated below.

Articles.	Fort Snelling.	Fort Sheridan.	Vancouver Barracks.	Fort Riley.	Fort Leavenworth.	Fort D. A. Russell.	Fort Douglas.	Fort Logan.	Fort Sam Houston.	Monterey.	Fort Casey.	Fort Flagler.	Fort Worden.	Fort Lawton.	Total.	Cost.	Total value.
Conical tents, complete	86	183	246	164	236	117	68	20	142	188	35	33	37	98	1,764	$36.91	$65,109.24
Hospital, complete	63	18	24	76	16	9	11	10	2	49	7	8	4	4	351	62.75	22,025.25
Wall, complete	101	63	29	230	259	60	37	39	33	99	12	17	16	32	1,178	29.34	34,562.52
Storage, complete	.....	.....	2	.....	6	.....	.....	.....	1	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	9	103.14	928.26
Total	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	.....	122,625.27

WAR DEPARTMENT, *Office of the Quartermaster-General, April 20 1906.*

[Memorandum for the Chief of Staff.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL,
Washington, April 20, 1906.

I send herewith official copies of telegrams sent and received relative to shipment of quartermaster's supplies from various depots to San Francisco, in pursuance to your instructions.

As stated in my memorandum of yesterday, the commanding generals and all the departments involved have been instructed to have all wall tents, conical wall tents, and hospital tents, at the following posts sent to San Francisco at once by express: Vancouver Barracks, Fort Logan, Fort Sam Houston, Fort Snelling, Fort Riley, Fort Douglas, Fort D. A. Russell, Presidio of Monterey, Fort Sheridan, Fort Leavenworth.

In every case the quartermasters and other officers involved have acknowledged receipt of the orders for shipment, and have either stated that the supplies had left or would be shipped within a few hours. As a matter of fact, most of it is on its way to San Francisco at the present time, by express.

Railroads are cooperating with the departments in expediting the shipment of this property, having given the supply trains right of way over all passenger and other trains. Instructions have just been sent to the depot quartermaster, St. Louis, to ship by express all common, conical, and hospital tents with necessary poles, tripods, etc., on hand at that depot, from those set aside for relief of flood sufferers, to San Francisco.

This Office is in receipt of a telegram from Governor Mead, of Washington, stating that he had between 300 and 400 tents available, which he could ship to San Francisco. Request has been sent to Governor Mead that he ship these tents, consigned to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, by first steamer.

Respectfully submitted.

C. F. HUMPHREY,
Quartermaster General, U. S. Army.

TELEGRAMS SENT.

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL DEPARTMENT OF CALIFORNIA,
San Francisco, Cal.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents, complete, that are now at Monterey.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *San Francisco:*

Telegraphic instructions given to commanding general Department of Missouri and commanding general Department Colorado to ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents, complete, at Forts Douglas, Logan, Leavenworth, and Riley.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *San Francisco:*

Following tentage ordered to you: From Philadelphia, 3,425 conical tents, with poles and tripods, and 10,169 joints pipe. From Omaha, 5,297 joints pipe and 3,500 stoves. From Chicago, 170,000 tent pins. From St. Louis, 1,824 joints pipe.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF CALIFORNIA,
San Francisco:

Am shipping blankets, mattresses, bed sacks, and additional tentage, which, with that ordered this morning, should accommodate 100,000 people. Can you use paulins?

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *San Francisco:*

In addition to tentage ordered to you from Philadelphia, Omaha, Chicago, St. Louis, and Forts Douglas, Logan, Leavenworth, and Riley, as advised in my two dispatches this morning, following additional tentage will be sent you by express: From Jeffersonville, 271 common tents, drab; 373 common tents, white; 6 hospital tents, drab; 2 hospital tents, khaki; 7,000 small tent pins; 12 hospital tent flies, white. From Philadelphia, 26 storage tent flies, 312 sets storage tent poles, 13 hospital tent flies, drab. From Omaha, 24 hospital tent flies, khaki. From Chicago, 312 storage tents. From St. Louis, 29 storage tents, 31 hospital tents, drab; 138 hospital tents, khaki; 11 white common tents, 231 drab common tents, 19,000 large and 32,000 small tent pins, 4 drab hospital tent flies, 124 hospital tent flies, khaki; 200 sets hospital tent poles, 900 sets common tent poles. From New York, 211 storage tent flies.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

General FUNSTON, *San Francisco:*

Have ordered Capt. Jesse M. Baker to accompany train load of rations and tentage to 'Frisco and report in person to you. He has had large experience in distribution of supplies, Johnstown flood, and think he will be useful for you.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Philadelphia:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, following tentage: One thousand nine hundred ninety-three common drab; 499 conical improved khaki, with poles; 13 regulation conical white, with poles; 124 hospital regulation drab; 873 hospital regulation khaki; 61 hospital flies, drab; 936 hospital flies, khaki; 34 improved hospital tents khaki, with poles; 25 improved hospital flies, khaki; 23 storage tents; 23 sets storage-tent poles; 6 regulation wall, drab, with poles; 2,455 regulation wall tents khaki, with poles; 304 regulation wall flies, drab; 2,157 regulation wall flies, khaki; 1,760 improved wall tents with poles; 1,760 wall flies; 329 sets conical tent poles, extra; 23,400 tent pins, large; 19,600 tent pins, small; 512 tent stoves; 4,310 joints stovepipe. Also 18,777 olive-drab blankets, 8,174 light-weight blankets, 7,478 mattresses, 11,400 bed sacks, 4,029 mattress covers. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire, and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Philadelphia, Pa.:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 3,425 regulation conical tents, complete. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Philadelphia:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all Gold Medal cots on hand at your depot. Acknowledge recept. Report number shipped and when shipment completed. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Philadelphia, Pa.:*

Reference telegram this morning. Send no tent pins and no stoves, but ship 10,169 joints pipe to San Francisco. All pins will go from Chicago, and all stoves and remainder of stovepipe from other depots. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Philadelphia:*

Two messages sent you regarding tentage. Matter thoroughly understood in this office. Carry out your orders with all dispatch.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

H. E. HOLLER, *Philadelphia, Pa.:*

. All emergency shipments for San Francisco are by express. Reference your telegram 19th.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Philadelphia:*

Ship by express at once to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, in addtition to tentage ordered this morning, 26 storage-tent flies, 312 sets storage-tent poles; 13 hospital-tent flies, drab. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COLONEL POPE,

Depot Quartermaster, Philadelphia, Pa.:

Please ascertain and let me know if supplies ordered from your depot to San Francisco will be sent out in solid train; and if not, in what manner they will be sent.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *St. Louis:*

Ship by express at once to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 29 storage tents; 31 hospital tents, drab; 138 hospital tents, khaki; 11 white common tents; 231 drab common tents; 19,000 large and 32,000 small tent pins; 4 hospital-tent flies, drab; 124 hospital-tent flies, khaki; 200 sets hospital-tent poles; 900 sets common tent poles. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *St. Louis:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 2 common tents, khaki, with poles; 23 storage tent flies; 1,993 sets common tent poles; 1,293 sets hospital poles; 21 sets conical wall tent poles; 31 hospital tents, drab; 138 hospital tents, khaki; 34 Munsons' hospital tents; 11 Munsons' hospital flies; 350 tent stoves; 612 light-weight blankets; 4,800 mattresses; 983 bed sacks; 4,926 mattress covers. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *St. Louis:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all gold-medal cots on hand at your depot. Acknowledge receipt. Report number shipped and when shipment completed. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *St. Louis:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 1,824 joints stovepipe. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Jeffersonville:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 68 sets wall-tent poles; 9 regulation conical tents, drab; 5 regulation conical, khaki; 7 regulation conical, white; 6 regulation hospital, drab; 2 regulation hospital, khaki; 25 regulation hospital, white; 2 regulation wall, khaki; 2 regulation wall flies, drab; 4,086 tent pins, large; 22,462 tent pins, small; 60,557 light-weight blankets; 47 mattresses; 1,426 bed sacks. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Jeffersonville:*

Ship by express at once to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 271 common tents, drab; 373 common tents, white; 6 hospital tents, drab; 2 hospital tents, khaki; 7,000 small tent pins; 12 hospital tent flies, white. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *Apr l 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *New York:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 22 improved conical tents, white; 307 regulation conical tents, khaki; 125 hospital regulation tents, khaki; 2 hospital regulation tents, white; 13,359 mattress covers. Acknowledge receipt. Re port when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *New York:*

Ship by express at once to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 211 storage-tent flies. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL DEPARTMENT LAKES,
Chicago, Ill.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents complete that are now at Fort Sheridan. Send competent officer with shipment to see to prompt delivery at San Francisco.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, *Chicago:*

Ship by express at once to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 312 storage tents. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, *Chicago:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 170,000 small tent pins and 500 joints stovepipe. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF THE LAKES,
Chicago, Ill.:

Reference your telegram this afternoon, Secretary War directs you send by Captain Hutton the 312 storage tents referred to by you.

McCAIN, *Military Secretary.*

NOTE.—Copy made from original filed by Colonel McCain in telegraph office at 9.50 p. m., April 19, 1906. Three hundred and twelve storage tents had already been ordered shipped, being in the Chicago depot.

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT MISSOURI,
Omaha, Nebr.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents, complete, that are now at Fort D. A. Russell. Send competent officer with ship to see to prompt delivery at San Francisco.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT MISSOURI,
Omaha, Nebr.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents, complete, at Forts Leavenworth and Riley. Send competent officers with shipment to see that prompt delivery is made at San Francisco.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, *Omaha:*

Ship by express at once to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 24 hospital tent flies, khaki. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, *Omaha, Nebr.:*

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 3,500 conical tent stoves and 5,297 joints stovepipe. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, *Omaha:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 849 wall tent pins, 51 mattresses, 283 bed sacks. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF COLORADO,
Denver, Colo.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents complete at Forts Douglas and Logan. Send competent officers with shipment to see that prompt delivery is made at San Francisco.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF TEXAS,
San Antonio, Tex.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents complete that are now at Fort Sam Houston. Send competent officer with shipment to see to prompt delivery at San Francisco.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF DAKOTA,
St. Paul, Minn.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents complete that are now at Fort Snelling. Send competent officer with shipment to see to prompt delivery at San Francisco.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF COLUMBIA,
Vancouver Barracks, Wash.:

Ship by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all wall, conical, and hospital tents complete now at Vancouver. Acknowledge receipt. Send competent officer with shipment to see to prompt delivery at San Francisco.

By order of the Secretary of War:

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Boston:*

Ship by express at once to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 6,567 olive drab blankets and 213 mattresses. Acknowledge receipt. Report when shipment complete. Follow through by wire and report arrival.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

Capt. JESSE M. BAKER, *Portland, Oreg.:*

Go with train to San Francisco and report to General Funston, who has been advised. Will secure orders to-morrow. By order of the Secretary of War.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

GOVERNOR OF NEBRASKA, *Lincoln, Nebr.:*

By authority of Secretary of War, you will ship by express to the depot quartermaster at San Francisco all tents and blankets now in hands of Nebraska National Guard.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

Gen. F. D. GRANT,
Commanding, Governors Island, N. Y.:

Your telegram to Military Secretary referred to me. Have shipped from general depots and larger posts in the West tentage for 100,000 people. Will of course draw on New York if more tentage is required after having taken what can be supplied from other points. Much of the tentage above referred to is now en route to San Francisco.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 19, 1906.*

COMMANDING-GENERAL, DEPARTMENT CALIFORNIA,
San Francisco, Cal.:

Am sending by express to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, from Jeffersonville depot 50 paulins, 18 by 30, and 300 paulins, 12 by 16; from New York depot 600 paulins, 18 by 30, and 300 paulins, 12 by 16.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, DEPARTMENT CALIFORNIA,
San Francisco:

Wire number of each kind of tents and parts thereof shipped from Monterey to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, under instructions of 19th instant.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *San Francisco:*

Governor of Nebraska has shipped to you by express all tents and blankets now in hands of Nebraska National Guard.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *San Francisco:*

Governor of Washington will ship to you by steamer between three and four hundred tents.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Philadelphia:*

The tentage received into stock April 1, and referred to in your telephonic message just received, will not be shipped to San Francisco for the present.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Philadelphia, Pa.:*

All tentage of Army now en route to San Francisco. Contractors have been urged to hasten deliveries of duck. Report what material you have on hand and how many tentmakers at work. Push manufacture of tents. What tents due to be manufactured on authorizations already given.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *St. Louis:*

Ship by express, at once, to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, all white common; drab, khaki, and white conical; drab, khaki, and white hospital tents and flies, with necessary poles and tripods, to be taken from those set aside for issue to flood sufferers. Send all such as are serviceable and fit for use. Acknowledge receipt. Follow through by wire and report arrival. Report number of each kind shipped and when shipment is complete.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *Jeffersonville, Ind.:*

Ship by express, immediately, to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 50 paulins, 18 by 30, and 300 paulins, 12 by 16. Acknowledge receipt. Report shipment by wire.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

DEPOT QUARTERMASTER, *New York:*

Ship by express, immediately, to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, 600 paulins, 18 by 30, and 300 paulins, 12 by 16. Acknowledge receipt. Report shipment by wire.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, DEPARTMENT LAKES, *Chicago:*

Wire number of each kind of tents and parts thereof shipped from Fort Sheridan to the depot quartermaster, San Francisco, under instructions of the 19th instant.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, *Chicago:*

Reference your telegram this date, ship no further storage tents to San Francisco in addition to the 312 ordered sent by this office on the 19th instant until further advised.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, DEPARTMENT OF MISSOURI,
Omaha, Nebr.:

Wire number of each kind of tents and parts thereof shipped from Forts Russell, Leavenworth, and Riley to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, under instructions of 19th instant, specifying quantity sent from each of the posts named.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, DEPARTMENT OF COLORADO,
Denver:

Wire number of each kind of tents and parts thereof shipped from Forts Douglas and Logan to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, under instructions of the 19th instant, specifying quantity sent from each of the posts named.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, DEPARTMENT OF TEXAS,
San Antonio, Tex.:

Wire number of each kind of tents and parts thereof shipped from Fort Sam Houston to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, under instructions of 19th instant.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, D. C., *April 20, 1906.*

CHIEF QUARTERMASTER, DEPARTMENT COLUMBIA,
Vancouver Barracks, Wash.:

Wire number of each kind of tents and parts thereof shipped from Vancouver Barracks under instructions of 19th instant.

C. F. HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

GOVERNOR OF NEBRASKA, *Lincoln, Nebr.:*

Wire number of each kind of tent and parts thereof, and blankets shipped by you to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, under authority 19th instant.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

WASHINGTON, *April 20, 1906.*

Governor MEAD, *Olympia, Wash.:*

Reference your telegram 19th instant, ship all available tents by steamer, consigned to depot quartermaster, San Francisco. Please wire number and kind transferred.

HUMPHREY, *Quartermaster-General.*

TELEGRAMS RECEIVED.

SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., *April 18, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Terrible earthquake at 5.15 this morning. Buildings on fire all over lower part of city. No water. Mission street quartermaster and commissary depots burned to the ground. Office building and storehouse, 36 Montgomery street, now on fire; small hope of saving. No fire at dock; pulled *Buford* out in stream. Saved most of records and sent to Presidio.

DEVOL, *Quartermaster.*

10.15 a. m.

PHILADELPHIA, PA., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Telegram received. Am sending tent stovepipe by express, as it is understood that it is to go with the tents.

POPE, *Depot Quartermaster.*

2.09 p. m.

CHICAGO, ILL., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Union and Southern Pacific officials report trains running to Oakland. Santa Fe officials report trains running to Point Richmond, Cal., and that slips on San Francisco side are all burned down, making it impracticable for ferryboats to land. They state they are putting barges on the route for transfer of freight and passengers.

ROBINSON, *Chief Quartermaster.*

2.32 p. m.

ST. LOUIS, MO., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington:*

Telegram this date directing shipment stovepipe to San Francisco received. Shipments complete, goes forward to-night.

VON SCHRADER, *Quartermaster.*

2.36 p. m.

OMAHA, NEBR., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Southern Pacific Railroad reports to Union Pacific officials here that their line is open for business to Oakland, Cal. Ferry between there and San Francisco doing only a limited business; no report from line between Oakland and San Francisco, but line understood to be badly embarrassed. Reference your telegram this date.

ZALINSKI, *Chief Quartermaster.*

4.41 p. m.

GOVERNORS ISLAND, N. Y., *April 19, 1906.*

THE MILITARY SECRETARY,
War Department, Washington, D. C.:

Referring to the calamity in San Francisco, there is on hand in this department, ready for immediate shipment in case desired 1,257 common tents, 1,001 conical tents, 577 wall tents, 182 hospital tents, 5,432 cots, and 1,066 tent stoves.

F. D. GRANT, *Commanding.*

4.47 p. m.

NEW YORK, *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington:*

Telegram directing express shipment to San Francisco 211 storage-tent flies received. All will go by Wells-Fargo express 8.30 to-night.

MILLER, *Depot Quartermaster.*

5.17 p. m.

CHICAGO, ILL., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Acknowledging receipt of your two telegrams to-day relative to storage tents, tent pins, and stovepipe, entire consignment will be shipped from here this evening and early morning to express. Will follow by wire and report delivery.

ROBINSON, *Chief Quartermaster.*

5.47 p. m.

ST. LOUIS, MO., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Your telegram this date, directing shipment certain tentage to San Francisco by express, received.

VON SCHRADER, *Quartermaster.*

5.51 p. m.

ST. LOUIS, MO., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Stovepipe ordered to San Francisco shipped via Wells-Fargo Express to-night, reference your wire this date.

VON SCHRADER, *Quartermaster.*

6.04 p. m.

PHILADELPHIA, PA., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Reference your telegram this date. Supplies for San Francisco will be sent out in two solid trains, one via Adams Express, the other via United States Express.

POPE, *Depot Quartermaster.*

6.38 p. m.

CHICAGO, ILL., *April 19, 1906.*

MILITARY SECRETARY, ARMY,
Washington, D. C.:

Captain Hutton, Twenty-seventh Infantry, leaves Fort Sheridan to-morrow night for San Francisco, taking 47 wall tents, 144 conical tents, and 17 hospital tents. If the 312 storage tents reported to-day available in this city desired, can go same shipment.

CARTER, *Commanding.*

6.47 p. m.

OMAHA, NEBR., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Shipment conical tent stoves and pipe and hospital tent flies directed in your telegrams to-day, loaded in three baggage cars, left here 5.20 p. m. by Pacific Express running as first section Union Pacific passenger train No. 3. Should reach San Francisco Sunday noon. Will follow by wire and report arrival to your office as soon as known. Depot quartermaster San Francisco notified of this shipment with numbers and initials of cars used.

ZALINSKI, *Chief Quartermaster.*

10.50 p. m.

ST. PAUL, MINN., *April 19, 1906.*

MILITARY SECRETARY,
War Department, Washington, D. C.:

Reference telegram this date from Chief of Staff, 101 wall, 86 conical, and 63 hospital tents from Fort Snelling shipped by express at 8.15 p. m. to-day under charge Captain Bjornstad, Twenty-eighth Infantry.

SWEET, *Commanding.*

11.43 p. m.

PHILADELPHIA, PA., *April 19, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

All supplies for San Francisco ordered in your telegrams of this date loaded in cars at 9 o'clock this evening. Both express companies state trains will leave by 9.45.

11.47 p. m. POPE, *Depot Quartermaster.*

BUFFALO, N. Y., *April 19, 1906.*

Hon. W. H. TAFT,
Secretary of War, Washington, D. C.

ESTEEMED SIR: The Enquirer would suggest that the Government at once send to the homeless people of stricken San Francisco a sufficient number of army tents to temporarily shelter the needy.

J. L. NIXON, *Managing Editor.*

OMAHA, NEBR., *April 20, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Receipt of telegram directing shipment of tent pins, mattresses, and bed sacks to depot quartermaster, San Francisco, by express acknowledged. Shipment will go forward to-day.

ZALINSKI, *Chief Quartermaster.*

12.42 p. m.

PRESIDIO OF SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., *April 20, 1906.*

QUARTERMASTER-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Answering yours a. m., issuing 3,000 common wall tents in store at Presidio storehouse; also 1,000 buckets, 1,000 blankets. Will continue issue until stock exhausted. Lack of water very serious. Can possibly take care of tentage as fast as it arrives. No stoves needed, owing to blowing cinders. Warehouses in some danger at Presidio. All storehouses in city totally destroyed with contents except storage of officers effects. Dock and all transports uninjured. Have moved records and office to Presidio.

DEVOL.

[Memorandum for the Chief of Staff.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE COMMISSARY-GENERAL,
Washington, April 20, 1906.

Shortly after 12 o'clock midnight, April 18, a telephone message was received from Mr. Carpenter to the effect that a telegram had been received from General Funston, stating that they were in need of subsistence supplies for the citizens of San Francisco who had been rendered destitute and homeless by the earthquake, and that the Secretary of War directed that rations should be sent. About 1 a. m. of the 19th the following telegram was sent:

DAVIS, *Commissary, Vancouver Barracks, Wash.:*

Purchase 200,000 rations and ship immediately to depot commissary, San Francisco. Greatest urgency. Have stores rushed forward without delay. Acknowledge receipt and state when and how shipment will be made.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

About 2 a. m. the following telegram was sent to General Funston:

FUNSTON, *San Francisco, Cal.:*

Secretary War directed commissary, Vancouver Barracks, to forward depot commissary, San Francisco, 200,000 rations. Is railroad open to Portland?

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

Early on the morning of the 19th the following telegram was received from the depot commissary at San Francisco:

COMMISSARY-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Depot destroyed by fire. Everything lost. Local troops supplied. Will wire in reference Manila shipments.

KRAUTHOFF.

The depot commissary at Denver was telegraphed as follows on the 19th:

WEST, *Commissary, Denver, Colo.:*

What number of rations can you obtain for immediate delivery in Denver? Can you have same shipped expeditiously to San Francisco? If so, by what means? Answer.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

To which he replied:

Following number rations can be obtained immediate delivery here: Bacon, 300,000; flour, 2,200,000; hard bread, 15,000; baking powder, 1,065,000; beans, 746,000; pease, 220,000; rice, 3,000,000; potatoes, 600,000; tomatoes, 984,000; coffee, roasted and ground, 887,000; teas, 1,350,000; salt, 6,750,000; pepper, 2,640,000; soap, 8,550,000; candles, 1,526,000. Same can be shipped expeditiously by fast freight; will reach San Francisco on seventh day from shipment, by express; sixty hours passenger service.

WEST, *Commissary.*

By direction of the Secretary, communicated through the Chief of Staff, additional shipment of 200,000 rations was ordered from Portland, as per the following telegram:

DAVIS, *Commissary, Vancouver Barracks, Wash.:*

Following telegram sent you last night: "Purchase 200,000 rations and ship immediately to depot commissary, San Francisco. Greatest urgency. Have stores rushed forward without delay. Acknowledge receipt and state when and how shipment will be made."

Add 200,000 rations to above order. Call on Geary for any portion of these stores you require. In connection with this revenue cutter *Perry*, Captain Tutle, will report to department commander transport rations to Frisco unless same can be more expeditiously forwarded by rail. What additional number of rations can you obtain in Portland? Answer.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

The subjoined is his reply:

Received telegram 18th midnight. Am shipping this afternoon 200,000 rations special train. Railroad promises to deliver early Saturday morning. Will ship 200,000 rations, order of 19th, special train to-morrow. Can purchase ample supplies here, Seattle, and Tacoma, but will have to improvise rations, as some articles can not be supplied at short notice. Railroad at present offers more expeditious way of sending than revenue cutter. Am gathering, on request of General Funston, all rations that can be spared from posts, all to be shipped to-day.

DAVIS, *Commissary.*

And the depot commissary at San Francisco was advised as follows:

By instructions Secretary of War 400,000 rations ordered shipped you by Davis, Vancouver, for issue to destitutes under instructions General Funston. Your wire received.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

On the 19th the purchasing commissary at Seattle was telegraphed as follows:

What number of rations can you obtain for immediate delivery in Seattle and Tacoma? Can you have same shipped expeditiously to San Francisco? If so, by what means? Answer.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

To which the following reply was received:

Can supply from here and vicinity 300,000 partial rations immediately. Quick transportation assured. If ordered to purchase, request authority to substitute for components not furnished.

GEARY, *Commissary.*

At 11 p. m. on the 19th I was instructed by the Secretary of War personally to ship 300,000 rations from Seattle, and sent the following telegram:

GEARY, *Commissary, Seattle, Wash.:*

Secretary of War directs purchase and immediate shipment of 300,000 partial rations. You are authorized to make substitutions. Invoice to depot commissary, Frisco. Acknowledge and give date shipment and probable date arrival Frisco.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

And the purchasing commissary at Vancouver was advised as follows:

Geary ordered ship 300,000 rations from Seattle. See that shipment is expedited from Portland.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

And the purchasing commissary at San Francisco as follows:

Secretary of War directed Geary to purchase 300,000 partial rations in Seattle and expedite shipment to you. This in addition to other orders. Notify us of arrival of first shipment of rations from Davis. Suggestions from you will be appreciated.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

On the 19th the following memorandum was sent to the Secretary of War:

I have the honor to recommend that General Funston be authorized to send one of the commissary officers on duty in San Francisco to Los Angeles and other surround-

ing places to purchase such supplies as may be needed for destitutes, not to exceed in quantity 200,000 rations. This in addition to the 400,000 rations already ordered from Portland.

HENRY G. SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

On the 19th the purchasing commissary at San Francisco was advised as follows:

Some supplies at Mare Island which can be obtained from Navy if required on transfer settlement. Secretary War approved recommendation commissary officer be sent to Los Angeles and surrounding country purchase supplies for destitutes not exceeding 200,000 rations in amount. These supplies to be paid for out of special appropriation made by Congress, designation to be furnished you later.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

The following telegrams were received from the purchasing commissary at San Francisco:

Stores due for Manila June 1 to July 5, can not be shipped from here.

Have sent you a number of telegrams. Impossible to get them through. Rations from Los Angeles, Portland, and Seattle will be a great addition. Am using everything that can be secured here in way of food. Request authority to hold Bottoms and Edwards.

To which reply was made as follows:

KRAUTHOFF, *Commissary, San Francisco, Cal.:*

Retain Edwards and Bottoms for present. Case now en route, report to you. Advise when Edwards can be spared. Do you need additional officers?

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

Also the following:

KRAUTHOFF, *Commissary, San Francisco, Cal.:*

Can you spare, temporarily, any clerks for Geary? If so, names. Is bottled water required for distribution? If so, quantity. Yours 19th received and action taken.

SHARPE.

This question in regard to bottled water was sent by direction of the Chief of Staff.

The following telegram was received on the 20th from the purchasing commissary, Seattle:

Wire directing purchase supplies received. Will ship by 25th and should arrive San Francisco 28th. Will ship about 50 tons provisions under orders from Colonel Davis to-morrow.

GEARY, *Commissary.*

To which the following reply was sent:

GEARY, *Commissary, Seattle, Wash.:*

Replying your telegram this date stating you will ship from Seattle on 25th, that date entirely too late. Ship such portion as you can by 22d, reporting deficiency at earliest date, which will be ordered from elsewhere.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

The following telegram has just been received from the purchasing commissary at Vancouver:

Am making shipment, special train from Seattle and here, 200,000 rations ordered 19th. Portland Chamber of Commerce has requested Subsistence Department to take charge of supplies they send. They desire distribution to be under direction of Army. Will try to wire Krauthoff.

DAVIS, *Commissary.*

The different purchasing commissaries were telegraphed to report what stores purchased by them were en route to Manila via San Francisco, so as to ascertain the quantities that might probably be lost in that city, so that duplicate orders for these supplies could be given for shipment to Manila. Definite information is not yet at hand, but probably very little, if any, stores en route from the East are lost.

As a summary it may be stated that 900,000 rations have been ordered purchased for issue to the destitute in San Francisco, at an estimated cost of 23 cents per ration, making $198,000.

An estimate of the stores lost in the depot in San Francisco, taken from the last returns received in this office, shows a loss of about $150,000. It appears from the telegrams of Colonel Davis, in Vancouver, that under General Funston's direction he has collected all the supplies from the posts in his department and forwarded them to San Francisco. It also appears from Major Krauthoff's telegram that he has been gathering all the food supplies that he can obtain. No estimate can possibly be made of the value of the stores obtained from these two sources. In order to ascertain something of this latter fact the following telegram was sent Colonel Davis at Vancouver, to which no reply has yet been received:

Wire us articles and amounts of stores shipped by you to San Francisco.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

HENRY G. SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

[Telegram.]

EAST BUFFALO, N. Y., *April 20, 1906.*

Gen. W. J. SHARPE,
Commissary-General, Washington, D. C.:

With your permission, would be glad to ship to General Funston, San Francisco, donation car fresh beef and provisions direct from our Wichita plant, including transportation, as our contribution toward efforts of War Department for relief of 'Frisco sufferers.

J. C. DOLD.

[Telegram.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE COMMISSARY-GENERAL.
April 20, 1906.

J. C. DOLD, *East Buffalo, N. Y.:*

Secretary War directs me to inform you that, as president National Red Cross Association, he accepts your most generous offer of a carload of fresh beef and provisions, as your contribution for the relief of the San Francisco sufferers, and expresses appreciation of this marked exhibition of your sympathy and patriotic sentiments. Please direct that the car be forwarded to San Francisco consigned to General Funston, and notify me date of shipment.

SHARPE, *Commissary-General.*

[Memorandum for the Secretary of War.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 21, 1906.

On the morning of the 19th, as soon as it became evident that there had been extensive destruction of property in San Francisco, arrangements were made for the

prompt shipment of medical supplies to replace those which might have been destroyed. The medical-supply officer at St. Louis, which is the nearest medical-supply depot to San Francisco, was instructed to pack and prepare for shipment, with packer's lists and bills of lading, general medical supplies according to the supply-table allowance for a population of 20,000 for a year. Authority was obtained from the Secretary of War for the shipment of five car loads of medical supplies by express. These were to include a field hospital and three regimental hospitals, with canvas, and all necessary supplies for three months and a general assortment of medicines and medical supplies to complete the loading of five cars.

A medical officer, who is appointed acting quartermaster for the purpose of the trip, was ordered to be sent with these supplies with a detachment of three hospital corps men to care for and handle the property.

Additional supplies are being prepared for shipment as soon as information is received from San Francisco as to their needs and capacity to handle and care for supplies.

The Surgeon-General on the 19th also consulted with the Surgeon-General of the Navy to arrange for the transfer of such medical supplies as might be needed from the naval medical supply depot at Mare Island to the chief surgeon, Department of California, and, by the courtesy of the honorable Secretary of the Navy, this arrangement was promptly made and telegraphed to the proper authorities.

Copies of all requisitions which had been sent to the San Francisco supply depot since April 1 for issue to posts about San Francisco and on the Pacific coast were made and sent to the St. Louis depot for issue from that depot, it being assumed that most of these supplies had not been yet issued from the San Francisco depot.

The chief surgeon, Department of California, has general authority to make emergency purchases of whatever may be necessary in the nearest cities.

The surgeon at Vancouver Barracks has been ordered to purchase in Portland and ship to San Francisco 10,000 meters of gauze and 100 pounds absorbent cotton.

As regards personnel: It was assumed that the Medical Department, for the purpose of caring for the sick and injured of the civil population of San Francisco, would make large use of civilian physicians and nurses, large numbers of whom would be homeless and without employment. This expectation has evidently been justified, as no requests for additional personnel have come from the chief surgeon, Department of California. Preparation has been made, however, to send Company A, of the Hospital Corps, with two medical officers, from this city to San Francisco.

The supply depot in San Francisco, which was entirely destroyed, was a large and important one, being the base for the Philippines. The total value of supplies therein, as figured from the quarterly return of stores of March 31, was $357,391.62. It will be necessary to replace these stores at once, but it is believed that this can not be done without exceeding the annual appropriation, which is barely adequate for the current needs of the Army for the year.

R. M. O'Reilly,
Surgeon-General U. S. Army.

[Memorandum for the Secretary of War.]

War Department, Office of the Surgeon-General,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

It seems certain from advices received that the medical supply depot, 655 Mission street, must have been destroyed by fire, which involves the loss of all reserve medical supplies on the Pacific coast. It is also evident that it will not be possible to purchase others in San Francisco. It is suggested, therefore, that five carloads of medical supplies be sent by express from the medical supply depot at St. Louis, with a medical officer, a sergeant, and two privates of the Hospital Corps, to establish a temporary depot at the Presidio, or the nearest Government reservation thereto, to which these supplies can be carried by rail, in order that the immediate needs of the situation may be met.

The approval of the Secretary is desired for making this shipment and for the transportation of the personnel above mentioned.

R. M. O'Reilly,
Surgeon-General U. S. Army.

Approved. Issue all orders necessary.

W. H. T.

[Telegram.]

WAR DEPARTMENT, OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

Lieut. Col. GEORGE H. TORNEY,
Deputy Surgeon-General, U. S. Army, Army General Hospital,
Presidio of San Francisco, Cal.:

Wire condition of medical supply depot and supplies; also what supplies will be needed. Lieutenant Powell, assistant surgeon, with detachment Hospital Corps, will accompany five carloads of medical supplies from St. Louis, sent by express, with orders to report to department commander for duty as Brechemin's assistant. Navy Department will authorize issue to Brechemin such needed medical supplies as can be spared from Mare Island depot. Act on all requisitions without reference to this office until further orders.

O'REILLY, *Surgeon-General.*

[Teiegram.]

FORT MASON, CAL., *April 19, 1906.*

SURGEON-GENERAL, UNITED STATES ARMY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Medical supply depot was destroyed totally. Nothing saved. Nothing can be purchased here. Will call on the naval authorities for surgical dressings. Will need at once 80,000 yards of gauze, 100 pounds of absorbent cotton, and 2 barrels of alcohol. Every provision is being made for the care of the sick. The division hospital has been erected and the post hospital opened. The difficulty in caring for the sick lies in the scarcity of water, which is sufficient for drinking and cooking only.

TORNEY, *Commanding Hospital.*

[Telegram.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

CRAMPTON,
Medical Supply Depot, 204 South Eighth Street, St. Louis, Mo.:

Medical supply depot, San Francisco, probably destroyed. Get ready for shipment, with invoices and bills of lading, twenty times annual allowance post of 1,000, paragraphs 246 to 258, inclusive. Use your discretion as to what furniture and other nonexpendable articles you will include. Be prepared also to ship one or two field hospitals and several regimental hospitals. You are authorized to employ temporarily such additional laborers as may be necessary. Acknowledge receipt.

O'REILLY, *Surgeon-General.*

[Telegram.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

Lieut. Col. LOUIS W. CRAMPTON,
Deputy Surgeon-General U. S. Army,
Medical Supply Depot, 204–208 South Eighth street, St. Louis, Mo.

The Secretary of War has authorized shipment of five carloads medical supplies by express. Assistant Surgeon Powell and detachment Hospital Corps will report to you to accompany it. Have them assist in loading, so as to be familiar with location of articles. Ship one field hospital, three regimental hospitals, and other supplies, as per telegram this morning. Add sufficient to make up five cars. Authority granted to purchase articles not on hand.

O'REILLY, *Surgeon-General.*

[Telegram.]

ST. LOUIS, MO., *April 19, 1906.*

SURGEON-GENERAL UNITED STATES ARMY,
Washington, D. C.

Telegram received. Will go to work at once for field and regimental hospital. Have all the chests and bedding, but no containers for the medicine. Authority requested to purchase articles not on hand.

CRAMPTON, *Lieutenant-Colonel.*

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

SIR: I have the honor to recommend that First Lieut. William A. Powell, assistant surgeon, now at Jefferson Barracks, Mo., be detailed as acting quartermaster, and with a sergeant and two privates, first class, or privates, Hospital Corps, to be selected by the commanding officer, Jefferson Barracks, be directed to proceed to St. Louis, Mo., and report in person to Lieut. Col. Louis W. Crampton, deputy surgeon-general, in charge of medical supply depot in that city, to accompany medical supplies to be forwarded by express to San Francisco, Cal., and upon arrival in that city Lieutenant Powell will report himself and his detachment to the commanding general, Department of California, for temporary duty as assistant to the medical supply officer.

It is requested that the order be communicated by telegraph.

Very respectfully,

R. M. O'REILLY,
Surgeon-General U. S. Army.

THE MILITARY SECRETARY OF THE ARMY.

[Telegram.]

THE MILITARY SECRETARY'S OFFICE,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

COMMANDING GENERAL, DEPARTMENT OF THE MISSOURI,
Omaha, Nebr.:

Secretary of War directs, as necessary for the public service, that you order First Lieut. William A. Powell, assistant surgeon, and two privates, first class, Hospital Corps, to be selected by the commanding officer, Jefferson Barracks, to proceed to St. Louis, Mo., and report in person to Lieutenant-Colonel Crampton, deputy surgeon-general, to accompany medical supplies to be forwarded by express to San Francisco, Cal., and upon arrival at that city Lieutenant Powell will be directed to report with his detachment to the commanding general, Department of California, for temporary duty as assistant to the medical supply officer. Lieut. William A. Powell is appointed acting quartermaster.

MCCAIN, *Acting Military Secretary.*

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

SIR: In view of the probable destruction of the medical supply depot, United States Army, 655 Mission street, San Francisco, and the possible need of medical supplies before a new stock can be sent, it is desired that the honorable Secretary of the Navy be requested to authorize, by telegraph, the issue to the Medical Department of the Army, upon requisition approved by the chief surgeon, Department of California, of such medical and hospital supplies as can be conveniently spared from the medical depot at Mare Island, California. These will he paid for, upon the receipt of bills, by the transfer of funds in the usual way to the proper appropriation.

Very respectfully,

R. M. O'REILLY,
Surgeon-General, U. S. Army.

THE MILITARY SECRETARY OF THE ARMY.

[Memorandum for the Secretary of War.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

This Office has not yet been informed that there is a necessity for sending trained nurses to San Francisco, but if the demand should be made for such assistance, it is believed that any number of competent nurses could be obtained and forwarded to that city on short notice.

R. M. O'REILLY,
Surgeon-General, U. S. Army.

[Telegram.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 19, 1906.

Asst. Surg. WILLIAM A. POWELL,
Jefferson Barracks, Mo.:

Pursuant to telegraphic orders sent you this day by Military Secretary you will take charge of the cars of medical supplies destined for San Francisco, telegraphing progress from time to time to the chief surgeon, general hospital, Presidio, and also to this Office. The Surgeon-General directs that you spare no exertion to deliver these supplies in San Francisco or nearest available point indicated by chief surgeon, and relies on you for success. You should get all necessary authority to control these supplies from the authorities of the express company in St. Louis.

O'REILLY, *Surgeon-General.*

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 20, 1906.

SURGEON-GENERAL UNITED STATES NAVY,
Navy Department, Washington, D. C.

SIR: I have the honor to furnish you with the following extract from a telegram dated April 19, received this morning, from the chief surgeon, Department of California:

"Will call on the naval authorities for surgical dressings."

Very respectfully, your obedient servant,

R. M. O'REILLY,
Surgeon-General U. S. Army.

[Telegram.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 20, 1906.

TORNEY,
Chief Surgeon, Department of California, Presidio, San Francisco, Cal.:

If you want the hospital corps company from Washington, about 100 enlisted men and 3 medical officers strong, telegraph me. Your telegram of yesterday received. Supplies ordered by express from St. Louis.

O'REILLY, *Surgeon-General.*

[Telegram.]

SAN FRANCISCO, CAL., *April 19, 1906.*

THE MILITARY SECRETARY, *Washington, D. C.:*

Don't use cipher in dispatches; codes have been destroyed.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

[Memorandum for the Chief of Staff.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 20, 1906.

In reply to your verbal request to be informed of the money value of the medical property destroyed by fire in the medical supply depot, 655 Mission street, San Francisco, Cal., I have the honor to state that a calculation based upon the quarterly return of March 31, 1906, shows it to be as follows:

Medical property, posts	$315,360.46
Medical property, field	36,585.54
Dental property	3,365.02
Depot's equipment	2,080.60
Total	357,391.62

R. M. O'REILLY,
Surgeon-General, U. S. Army.

[Telegram.]

ST. LOUIS, MO., *April 20, 1906.*

SURGEON-GENERAL, UNITED STATES ARMY,
Washington, D. C.:

No express cars available to-day. Am rushing things as much as possible. Hope to leave here Saturday night.

POWELL, *Assistant Surgeon.*

[Telegram.]

ST. LOUIS, MO., *April 20, 1906.*

SURGEON-GENERAL UNITED STATES ARMY,
Washington, D. C.:

Telegrams of yesterday p. m. and to-day received. Cars are promised to-morrow morning, when loading will begin. It is estimated that twenty or more cars will be required to make whole shipment. Shall I send in the five cars a percentage of articles most needed and the balance to follow by freight? What is most needed?

CRAMPTON.

2.12 p. m.

[Telegram.]

HEADQUARTERS OF DEPARTMENT,
Fort Mason, Cal., April 20, 1906.

SURGEON-GENERAL, *Washington, D. C.:*

Your offer send company 100 men, Hospital Corps, to assist Colonel Torney received at these headquarters. Request they be sent immediately. They will be very much needed in the near future. Please communicate copy this message to Military Secretary.

FUNSTON, *Commanding.*

WAR DEPARTMENT, OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 21, 1906.

SIR: I have the honor to request that Capt. Harry L. Gilchrist, assistant surgeon, U. S. Army, and First Lieut. William T. Davis, assistant surgeon, U. S. Army, with 100 men from Company A, Hospital Corps, be directed to proceed with the least possible delay from Washington Barracks, D. C., to San Francisco, Cal., and report

to the commanding general, Department of California, for duty. Captain Gilchrist should be directed to take with him a field hospital complete and thirty days' rations.

First Lieutenant Davis should be appointed quartermaster.

Very respectfully,

R. M. O'REILLY,
Surgeon-General, U. S. Army.

THE MILITARY SECRETARY,
War Department.

[Telegram.]

WAR DEPARTMENT,
OFFICE OF THE SURGEON-GENERAL,
Washington, April 21, 1906.

FLAGG, *Surgeon, Vancouver Barracks, Wash.:*

Purchase and ship by express to chief surgeon, Presidio of San Francisco, 10,000 meters of gauze and 50 kilos absorbent cotton. Wire action taken and estimate of cost.

O'REILLY, *Surgeon-General.*

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